

BLACK HISTORY 365

African American History Challenge — Study Outline
Units 5–7 · Chapters 11–24 · Chronological by Chapter

Each event includes a concise summary followed by verified Who / What / When / Where / Why. All events cross-referenced against historical record. Verify any statistic against your BH365 textbook before competition.

Chapter Index

Ch.	Chapter Title	Unit
11	The Great Migration	5
12	President Woodrow Wilson and Federal Segregation	5
13	Push-Pull Factors and Black Leadership Ideologies	5
14	The Harlem Renaissance	5
15	The Black Church	5
16	The Civil Rights Movement — Foundations	6
17	The Birmingham Children's Crusade	6
18	Freedom Fighters and Civil Rights Organizations	6
19	Black Women in the Civil Rights Movement	6
20	Convict Labor and the Roots of the Economic System	7
21	HBCUs, Financial Literacy, and Wealth Building	7
22	Black Entrepreneurs and Economic Empowerment	7
23	Barack Obama, Mary McLeod Bethune, and the Presidency	7
24	Language, Oppression, and Identity	7

UNIT 5 — THE GREAT MIGRATION

Chapter 11: The Great Migration

■ The Great Migration

6+ million Black Americans fled Jim Crow oppression in the South (1915–1970), relocating to northern and western cities for jobs, safety, and civil rights.

**WH
O** Over 6 million Black Americans

**WH
AT** Massive exodus from the rural South to northern and western urban centers

**WH
EN** 1915–1970 (first wave: 1915–1940; second wave: 1940–1970)

**WH
ERE** Southern states → Northeast, Midwest, and West (especially New York, Chicago, Detroit)

**WH
Y** Escape Jim Crow racial terror, disfranchisement, and economic exploitation; seek industrial jobs, voting rights, and better schools in the North

■ Jim Crow Laws

Jim Crow laws (1877–1965) legally enforced racial segregation across the South, stripping Black Americans of civil rights, economic opportunity, and physical safety.

**WH
O** Southern state legislatures and local governments (perpetrators); Black Americans (targets)

**WH
AT** State and local laws mandating racial segregation in virtually all public settings — schools, transportation, restaurants, restrooms, hospitals, courtrooms

**WH
EN** 1877–1965

**WH
ERE** Southern United States (and in practice much of the North through custom)

**WH
Y** White supremacist political power sought to entrench racial hierarchy and economic exploitation after Reconstruction's federal oversight ended

■ Black Population Growth in Northern Cities

Between 1910–1930, Black populations surged dramatically in northern cities — Detroit by over 600%, Chicago 150%, New York 66% — reshaping urban America.

**WH
O** Black migrants from the South; northern municipal governments

**WH
AT** Dramatic demographic shifts: New York's Black population +66%, Chicago +150%, Detroit +600% between 1910 and 1930

**WH
EN** 1910–1930

**WH
ERE** New York City, Chicago, and Detroit primarily

**WH
Y** Industrial labor demand (especially WWI), higher wages, and escape from Southern racial violence drove concentrated migration to these cities

■ Annie Turnbo Malone — Hair Care Pioneer and Philanthropist

Annie Turnbo Malone built the Poro Company in St. Louis (late 1890s), becoming a Black female millionaire and major philanthropist — and launched Sarah Breedlove (Madam C.J. Walker) as her sales agent before Walker created her own line.

WH O	Annie Turnbo Malone
WH AT	Created and marketed hair care products for Black women; founded the Poro Company; trained thousands of agents; became a millionaire; gave generously to Black institutions
WH EN	Late 1890s – 1930s
WH ERE	St. Louis, Missouri
WH Y	Identified an unmet market for Black hair care products and used her wealth to advance Black community institutions and education

■ Black Entrepreneurship in Northern Cities

Excluded from white businesses, Black migrants built a parallel urban economy in the 1910s–30s — founding banks, beauty shops, funeral homes, and professional associations.

WH O	Black migrants and established Black residents
WH AT	Established restaurants, taverns, bakeries, barbershops, beauty shops, funeral businesses, trucking firms, banks, and professional associations
WH EN	1910s–1930s
WH ERE	Black urban neighborhoods in Chicago, New York, Detroit, and other northern cities
WH Y	Excluded from white-owned businesses and institutions, Black Americans built parallel economic structures within their own communities

Chapter 12: President Woodrow Wilson and Federal Segregation

■ Woodrow Wilson — 28th President

Wilson won the 1912 presidency with Black voter support after promising social justice — then systematically betrayed those promises once in office.

WH O	Woodrow Wilson; W.E.B. Du Bois and Black voters who supported him
WH AT	Wilson won the 1912 presidential election with significant Black support after campaigning on progressive themes including social justice
WH EN	1912 election; presidency 1913–1921
WH ERE	United States
WH Y	Du Bois and many Black voters believed Wilson's progressive rhetoric signaled genuine support for Black equality — a miscalculation

■ Wilson Re-segregates Federal Government

Within months of taking office in 1913, Wilson re-segregated the Post Office and Treasury, required photos on applications to screen out Black applicants, and reversed decades of post-Reconstruction federal integration.

WH O	President Woodrow Wilson; Treasury Secretary William McAdoo; Postmaster General Albert Burleson
WH AT	Wilson's administration re-segregated federal departments including the Post Office and Treasury; required photographs on job applications enabling racial discrimination; segregated restrooms, cafeterias, and workspaces
WH EN	1913
WH ERE	Washington, D.C. — federal agencies nationwide
WH Y	Wilson held white supremacist views and believed segregation reduced racial 'friction'; reversed decades of federal integration achieved since Reconstruction

■ W.E.B. Du Bois Condemns Wilson in the CRISIS

Du Bois published a scathing open letter in the CRISIS (1913) condemning Wilson's federal segregation as a direct betrayal of the Black voters who helped elect him.

WH O	W.E.B. Du Bois (author); the CRISIS magazine (NAACP publication)
WH AT	Du Bois published an open letter in the CRISIS magazine sharply criticizing Wilson's racial betrayal and federal segregation policies
WH EN	1913
WH ERE	The CRISIS magazine, nationally distributed
WH Y	Wilson had betrayed the Black community that helped elect him; Du Bois felt obligated to publicly condemn the reversal

■ Andrew Johnson vs. Woodrow Wilson — Broken Presidential Promises

Both Johnson (Reconstruction era) and Wilson (Progressive era) promised support for Black equality but governed in ways that entrenched racial oppression — a recurring pattern in American presidential history.

WH O	Presidents Andrew Johnson (1865–1869) and Woodrow Wilson (1913–1921)
WH AT	Both presidents made public statements supporting racial equality but governed in ways that entrenched racial oppression — Johnson undermined Reconstruction; Wilson re-segregated the federal government
WH EN	Johnson: 1865–1869; Wilson: 1913–1921
WH ERE	Federal government, United States
WH Y	Political expedience and personal racial ideology repeatedly led presidents to abandon Black Americans despite stated commitments

■ Push-Pull Factors of the Great Migration

The Great Migration was driven by Southern racial terror, economic exploitation, and disfranchisement (push) paired with Northern industrial wages, schools, and relative freedom (pull).

WH O	Millions of Black Americans making individual and family migration decisions
WH AT	Push factors: racial terror (lynching, riots), disfranchisement, debt peonage, sharecropping exploitation, legal exclusion. Pull factors: industrial wages, voting rights, better schools, reduced (though not absent) racial violence
WH EN	1915–1940 (peak first wave)
WH ERE	South (push) → Midwest, Northeast, West Coast (pull)
WH Y	The combination of intolerable conditions in the South and genuine (if imperfect) opportunity in the North made migration a rational survival strategy

■ Du Bois vs. Booker T. Washington — The Great Debate

Washington's 1895 Atlanta Compromise advocated vocational training and political accommodation; Du Bois countered with demands for immediate civil rights — this foundational debate shaped Black politics for generations.

WH O	W.E.B. Du Bois (advocate for immediate full civil and political rights) vs. Booker T. Washington (advocate for vocational training, economic self-sufficiency, and accommodation)
WH AT	Fundamental ideological split over the best strategy for Black advancement: immediate political equality (Du Bois) vs. gradual economic uplift and accommodation to white power (Washington)
WH EN	Peaked 1895 (Washington's Atlanta Compromise speech) through 1915 (Washington's death)
WH ERE	National Black intellectual and political sphere; Atlanta and Tuskegee vs. the NAACP
WH Y	Both leaders faced the same crisis of racial oppression but reached different strategic conclusions about what was achievable and at what cost

■ Marcus Garvey and the UNIA

Marcus Garvey's UNIA (1914) built the largest Black mass movement in history, promoting Pan-African nationalism, the Black Star Line, and a 'Back to Africa' vision as the path to Black liberation.

WH O	Marcus Garvey; Universal Negro Improvement Association (UNIA)
WH AT	Founded UNIA; launched 'Back to Africa' movement; promoted Black nationalism, racial pride, and economic self-sufficiency; published Negro World newspaper; organized Black Star Steamship Line
WH EN	UNIA founded 1914 in Jamaica; major U.S. expansion 1916–1927
WH ERE	Jamaica (origin) → Harlem, New York → international reach
WH Y	Garvey believed Black people could never achieve true freedom or dignity in white-dominated Western societies; Pan-African return was the solution

■ Elaine, Arkansas Massacre

White mobs massacred 100–237 Black sharecroppers in Elaine, AR (Sept. 1919) after they organized a union — one of the deadliest acts of racial terror in U.S. history.

WH O	Black sharecroppers (organized by Progressive Farmers and Household Union); white mobs; Arkansas state militia; federal troops
WH AT	White mobs and militia massacred an estimated 100–237 Black sharecroppers after they organized a union to negotiate fair cotton prices; 12 men sentenced to death; over 100 imprisoned
WH EN	September 30 – October 1, 1919 (part of the 'Red Summer' of 1919)
WH ERE	Elaine, Phillips County, Arkansas
WH Y	White landowners and local government feared Black economic organization would disrupt the exploitative sharecropping system; union organizing was treated as an act of rebellion

■ The Green Book

Victor Hugo Green's annual Green Book (1936–1966) was an essential survival guide listing businesses and lodging safe for Black travelers navigating a violently segregated America.

WH O	Victor Hugo Green (author/publisher); Black travelers nationwide
WH AT	Annual travel guide listing hotels, restaurants, beauty parlors, and businesses safe for Black travelers in a segregated America
WH EN	Published annually 1936–1966
WH ERE	Published in Harlem, New York; distributed nationally and internationally
WH Y	Black travelers faced life-threatening dangers from segregation, sundown towns, and racist violence; the guide made travel survivable

Chapter 14: The Harlem Renaissance

■ The Harlem Renaissance

The Great Migration concentrated Black genius in Harlem (1920s–30s), igniting an explosion of literature, jazz, visual art, and political thought that redefined Black identity and permanently shaped American culture.

WH O	Black writers, poets, musicians, visual artists, and intellectuals including Langston Hughes, Zora Neale Hurston, Duke Ellington, Louis Armstrong, Aaron Douglas, and Claude McKay
WH AT	An unprecedented outpouring of Black artistic, literary, and intellectual achievement spanning poetry, fiction, jazz, blues, visual art, and political thought
WH EN	1920s–1930s
WH ERE	Harlem, New York City (epicenter); influence spread nationally and internationally
WH Y	The Great Migration concentrated Black talent and energy in Harlem; artists responded to the need to assert Black humanity, beauty, and intellectual depth in defiance of white supremacy

■ Langston Hughes — Poet of the People

Langston Hughes (1920s–1967) revolutionized American poetry by embedding jazz rhythms and Black vernacular into verse celebrating Black life and demanding dignity — becoming the defining literary voice of the Harlem Renaissance.

WH O	Langston Hughes
WH AT	Prolific poet, playwright, novelist, and essayist who celebrated Black everyday life, culture, and beauty while condemning racial injustice; incorporated jazz and blues rhythms into poetry
WH EN	Active 1920s–1967
WH ERE	Harlem, New York City; nationally and internationally influential
WH Y	Hughes believed Black artists had a responsibility to express their authentic experience without seeking white validation or approval

Chapter 15: The Black Church

■ Growth of Independent Black Churches Post-Civil War

After emancipation (1865–1905), Black Americans built 30,000+ independent churches with 3.3M+ members — the largest, most stable institutional network in Black America, surpassing HBCUs, the Urban League, and the NAACP.

WH O	Black congregations; AME, AME Zion, and Baptist denominations; Black clergy
WH AT	Explosive growth from roughly 700,000 Black church members in 1865 to well over 3.3 million members across 30,000+ churches by approximately 1903–1906
WH EN	1865–1905
WH ERE	Throughout the United States, concentrated in the South but expanding nationally
WH Y	Emancipation gave Black Americans freedom to build independent spiritual and community institutions no longer controlled by white slaveholders

■ The Black Church as Cornerstone of Civil Rights

The Black church (1950s–60s) was the organizational backbone of the Civil Rights Movement — providing meeting spaces, funding, communication, and the moral authority of the clergy that no other institution could match.

WH O	Black clergy (notably Dr. Martin Luther King Jr., Ralph Abernathy, Fred Shuttlesworth); Black congregations; the SCLC
WH AT	Black churches provided meeting spaces, financial support, communication networks, and moral authority for Civil Rights organizing from Montgomery to the March on Washington
WH EN	1950s–1960s (peak Civil Rights era; tradition of resistance extends back to slavery)
WH ERE	Throughout the South and North
WH Y	The Black church was the one institution that could not be controlled, defunded, or shuttered by white economic or political power — making it the irreplaceable backbone of the movement

■ Black Women's Leadership in the Church

Though barred from most pulpits, Black women were the organizational and moral engine of Black churches — leading auxiliaries, shaping policy, and wielding substantial influence over clergy through their rhetorical and spiritual authority.

WH O	Black women church members, deaconesses, and auxiliary leaders
WH AT	Black women led mission auxiliaries, prayer bands, and fundraising organizations; shaped church doctrine through moral guidance; influenced clergy despite formal exclusion from the pulpit
WH EN	Late 19th century through 20th century
WH ERE	Black churches nationwide
WH Y	Despite formal exclusion from ordained ministry, Black women were the organizational engine and moral conscience of the Black church

UNIT 6 — CIVIL RIGHTS AND AMERICAN JUSTICE

Chapter 16: The Civil Rights Movement — Foundations

■ Plessy v. Ferguson — 'Separate But Equal'

Plessy v. Ferguson (1896) enshrined 'separate but equal' as constitutional law, giving legal sanction to Jim Crow segregation for nearly six decades until overturned by Brown v. Board (1954).

WH O	Homer Plessy (plaintiff); Justice Henry Billings Brown (majority opinion); Justice John Marshall Harlan (lone dissent); Louisiana state government
WH AT	Supreme Court ruled 7–1 that racial segregation was constitutional under the 'separate but equal' doctrine, upholding Louisiana's Separate Car Act
WH EN	May 18, 1896
WH ERE	U.S. Supreme Court, Washington, D.C.; originated on a New Orleans railroad car
WH Y	Louisiana law required separate railroad cars for Black and white passengers; Plessy deliberately challenged it; the court's ruling entrenched Jim Crow nationwide for 58 years

■ Executive Order 9981 — Military Desegregation

Truman's Executive Order 9981 (July 26, 1948) desegregated the U.S. military, the largest institutional desegregation in American history up to that point — a direct response to Black WWII veterans' demands.

WH O	President Harry S. Truman; Black WWII veterans who demanded equal treatment
WH AT	Executive order mandating equality of treatment and opportunity in the U.S. armed forces regardless of race, color, religion, or national origin
WH EN	July 26, 1948
WH ERE	United States military, worldwide
WH Y	Black WWII veterans returning home faced continued segregation and racial violence; Truman responded to civil rights pressure and Cold War propaganda concerns about American racial hypocrisy

■ Brown v. Board of Education

Brown v. Board (May 17, 1954) unanimously overturned Plessy v. Ferguson, ruling school segregation unconstitutional — the single most important legal victory of the Civil Rights Movement, though resistance to implementation was fierce.

WH O	Oliver Brown et al. (plaintiffs); Thurgood Marshall and NAACP Legal Defense Fund; Chief Justice Earl Warren (unanimous opinion)
WH AT	Supreme Court unanimously ruled that racial segregation in public schools was inherently unequal and unconstitutional under the 14th Amendment, overturning Plessy v. Ferguson
WH EN	May 17, 1954
WH ERE	U.S. Supreme Court; originated in Topeka, Kansas public school system
WH Y	NAACP's legal strategy argued that separate schools caused irreparable psychological and educational harm to Black children; Warren's court agreed unanimously

■ Rosa Parks and the Montgomery Bus Boycott

Rosa Parks' arrest (Dec. 1, 1955) triggered a 381-day Montgomery Bus Boycott that ended bus segregation, launched Dr. King nationally, and proved that sustained nonviolent economic pressure could defeat Jim Crow.

WH O	Rosa Parks (catalyst); Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. (boycott leader); Montgomery Improvement Association; 50,000+ Black Montgomery residents
WH AT	Parks refused to give up her bus seat to a white man; her arrest triggered a 381-day community boycott that ended bus segregation in Montgomery and launched King to national prominence
WH EN	Parks arrested: December 1, 1955; boycott ended December 20, 1956
WH ERE	Montgomery, Alabama
WH Y	Years of humiliation and abuse of Black bus riders reached a breaking point; Parks' arrest — though not the first — became the planned catalyst for a prepared community response

■ James Meredith Integrates the University of Mississippi

James Meredith's enrollment at Ole Miss (Sept. 30, 1962) required 31,000 federal troops, triggered deadly riots, and became the defining showdown between federal authority and Southern massive resistance to desegregation.

WH O	James Meredith (first Black student); U.S. Marshals and federal troops; Governor Ross Barnett (defying federal authority); white rioters
WH AT	Meredith enrolled as the first Black student at Ole Miss; his arrival triggered riots killing 2 people and injuring 300+; Kennedy deployed 31,000 federal troops to enforce his enrollment
WH EN	September 30, 1962
WH ERE	University of Mississippi, Oxford, Mississippi
WH Y	Mississippi had defied federal desegregation law; Meredith sued for admission, won in federal court, and the Kennedy administration was forced to enforce the ruling militarily

■ March on Washington for Jobs and Freedom

The March on Washington (Aug. 28, 1963) drew 250,000 people to the Lincoln Memorial, where King's 'I Have a Dream' speech became the defining oration of the Civil Rights Movement and accelerated passage of the Civil Rights Act.

WH O	250,000+ participants; Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. ('I Have a Dream'); John Lewis; Bayard Rustin (chief organizer); A. Philip Randolph
WH AT	Largest civil rights demonstration in U.S. history at that time; King delivered 'I Have a Dream'; speakers demanded the Civil Rights Act and federal jobs program
WH EN	August 28, 1963
WH ERE	National Mall and Lincoln Memorial, Washington, D.C.
WH Y	Build political pressure on Congress and President Kennedy to pass civil rights and economic legislation; demonstrate the breadth of support for the movement

■ 15th Amendment — Right to Vote

The 15th Amendment (ratified 1870) guaranteed Black men the right to vote — then was systematically nullified for nearly 100 years by Southern disenfranchisement tactics until the Voting Rights Act of 1965.

WH O	U.S. Congress; President Ulysses S. Grant; formerly enslaved Black men
WH AT	Constitutional amendment prohibiting denial of the right to vote based on 'race, color, or previous condition of servitude'
WH EN	Passed February 26, 1869; ratified February 3, 1870
WH ERE	United States
WH Y	Ensure Black men the right to vote during Reconstruction; later systematically gutted by poll taxes, literacy tests, grandfather clauses, and racial terror — necessitating the Voting Rights Act nearly a century later

■ John Howard Griffin's Black Like Me Experiment

John Howard Griffin's Black Like Me (1961) documented his experience traveling the Deep South as a Black man, confronting white Americans with the lived reality of racial oppression they had ignored or denied.

WH O	John Howard Griffin, white journalist
WH AT	Griffin, a white man, darkened his skin with medication and traveled through the Deep South passing as a Black man; documented the experience in the 1961 book Black Like Me
WH EN	1959 (experiment); 1961 (book published)
WH ERE	Deep South — Louisiana, Mississippi, Alabama, Georgia
WH Y	Griffin wanted to understand what it actually meant to be Black in the American South; the book shocked white readers into confronting the reality of racial oppression

Chapter 17: The Birmingham Children's Crusade

■ The Birmingham Children's Crusade

In May 1963, hundreds of Birmingham children marched for civil rights; Bull Connor's police attacked them with fire hoses and dogs. The images shocked the world, broke the Birmingham standoff, and accelerated federal civil rights legislation.

WH O	Hundreds of Black children (ages 6–18); organized by James Bevel (SCLC); Commissioner of Public Safety Bull Connor
WH AT	Children marched in waves from 16th Street Baptist Church; Connor's police attacked them with fire hoses and police dogs; over 1,000 children arrested
WH EN	May 2–10, 1963
WH ERE	Birmingham, Alabama — from 16th Street Baptist Church through downtown
WH Y	Adult protesters risked losing jobs and livelihoods; children volunteered knowing they faced less economic retaliation; their courage and the brutality against them shocked the world and broke the Birmingham standoff

■ 16th Street Baptist Church Bombing

KKK bombers killed four Black girls at Birmingham's 16th Street Baptist Church on Sept. 15, 1963. The murders galvanized national and international outrage and hardened congressional resolve to pass the Civil Rights Act.

WH O	KKK members Robert Chambliss, Thomas Blanton, Bobby Frank Cherry, and Herman Cash (perpetrators); Addie Mae Collins, Cynthia Wesley, Carole Robertson, and Carol Denise McNair (four girls killed, ages 11–14)
WH AT	KKK bombed 16th Street Baptist Church — headquarters of Civil Rights organizing in Birmingham — killing four Black girls and injuring 22 others
WH EN	September 15, 1963
WH ERE	16th Street Baptist Church, Birmingham, Alabama
WH Y	The KKK targeted the church because it was the organizational hub of Birmingham's civil rights campaign; the bombing was intended to terrorize and demoralize the movement

Chapter 18: Freedom Fighters and Civil Rights Organizations

■ Southern Christian Leadership Conference (SCLC)

The SCLC (1957, Atlanta) coordinated nonviolent civil rights campaigns through the Black church network, under King's leadership, executing the Birmingham Campaign, Selma marches, and March on Washington.

WH O	Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. (president); Ralph Abernathy; Fred Shuttlesworth; Joseph Lowery; Ella Baker (early director)
WH AT	National civil rights organization coordinating nonviolent direct action campaigns through the Black church network
WH EN	Founded January 10–11, 1957
WH ERE	Atlanta, Georgia (headquarters)
WH Y	The success of the Montgomery Bus Boycott demonstrated the power of organized nonviolent resistance; church leaders sought a coordinating organization to replicate it nationally

■ Student Nonviolent Coordinating Committee (SNCC)

SNCC (1960) was the student wing of the Civil Rights Movement, leading sit-ins, Freedom Rides, voter registration, and Freedom Summer — and later under Stokely Carmichael, introducing the 'Black Power' slogan.

WH O	Student sit-in activists; Ella Baker (faculty advisor); John Lewis (later chairman); Diane Nash; Stokely Carmichael
WH AT	Student-led civil rights organization that coordinated sit-ins, Freedom Rides, voter registration drives, and Freedom Summer
WH EN	Founded April 1960
WH ERE	Shaw University, Raleigh, North Carolina (founding); operations throughout the South
WH Y	Young activists wanted an independent student-led organization not controlled by the older generation of civil rights leadership

■ The Black Panther Party

The Black Panther Party (1966, Oakland) combined armed self-defense against police brutality with revolutionary community programs — free breakfasts, health clinics, and schools — becoming a defining force of Black Power.

WH O	Huey P. Newton and Bobby Seale (co-founders); Eldridge Cleaver; Angela Davis (associate)
WH AT	Founded to combat police brutality; operated community programs including free breakfast for children, health clinics, and legal aid; championed armed self-defense
WH EN	Founded October 1966
WH ERE	Oakland, California; chapters in major cities nationwide
WH Y	Nonviolent approaches had not stopped police killings of Black people; Newton and Seale argued Black communities had a constitutional right to armed self-defense

■ The Freedom Riders

Freedom Riders (1961) rode interstate buses through the South to enforce desegregation rulings, enduring fire-bombings and mob beatings in Alabama. Their courage forced the Kennedy administration to desegregate interstate transportation facilities.

WH O	CORE and SNCC volunteers — Black and white (including John Lewis, James Lawson, Diane Nash); James Farmer (CORE director)
WH AT	Interracial groups rode interstate buses through the Deep South to challenge segregation in terminal facilities, defying the Supreme Court's <i>Boynton v. Virginia</i> ruling; attacked by violent mobs in Anniston and Birmingham
WH EN	May – December 1961
WH ERE	Washington, D.C. → Virginia → the Carolinas → Georgia → Alabama (Anniston, Birmingham, Montgomery) → Mississippi
WH Y	The Supreme Court had ruled segregated interstate bus terminals unconstitutional in <i>Boynton v. Virginia</i> (1960), but Southern states refused to comply; riders forced federal enforcement

■ Freedom Summer

Freedom Summer (1964) sent 1,000 volunteers to Mississippi to register Black voters and operate Freedom Schools. Three workers — Chaney, Goodman, and Schwerner — were murdered. The campaign directly led to the Voting Rights Act of 1965.

WH O	SNCC and COFO; approximately 1,000 volunteers (mostly northern white college students alongside Black Mississippians); Fannie Lou Hamer; Bob Moses
WH AT	Massive Mississippi voter registration campaign; established 40+ Freedom Schools serving 2,500+ students; created the Mississippi Freedom Democratic Party; three volunteers (Chaney, Goodman, Schwerner) murdered
WH EN	Summer 1964
WH ERE	Mississippi — particularly the Delta region
WH Y	Only 6.7% of eligible Black Mississippians were registered; systematic terror prevented registration; national volunteers were brought in to force federal attention

■ Assassination of Dr. Martin Luther King Jr.

Dr. King was assassinated at the Lorraine Motel in Memphis on April 4, 1968, while supporting striking Black sanitation workers. Riots erupted in 110+ cities; Congress passed the Fair Housing Act within a week.

WH O	Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. (victim); James Earl Ray (convicted assassin); James Orange and sanitation workers (King's Memphis mission)
WH AT	King was shot by a sniper on the balcony of the Lorraine Motel; died at 7:05 p.m. Riots erupted in over 110 American cities; the Civil Rights Act of 1968 (Fair Housing Act) passed within a week
WH EN	April 4, 1968
WH ERE	Lorraine Motel, Memphis, Tennessee
WH Y	King was in Memphis supporting striking Black sanitation workers fighting for dignity and fair wages; he was the most prominent target of white supremacist hatred in America

Chapter 19: Black Women in the Civil Rights Movement

■ Fannie Lou Hamer — Courage Under Terror

Fannie Lou Hamer (1962) registered to vote in Mississippi, was beaten and evicted, then electrified the nation with her 1964 DNC testimony — 'I'm sick and tired of being sick and tired' — demanding Mississippi's Black voters be seated.

WH O	Fannie Lou Hamer, Mississippi sharecropper and SNCC leader
WH AT	Registered to vote (1962) and was immediately evicted from the plantation; jailed and beaten in Winona, Mississippi (1963); testified before the Credentials Committee at the 1964 Democratic National Convention in a nationally televised speech
WH EN	Active 1962–1977
WH ERE	Sunflower County, Mississippi; Winona, Mississippi; Atlantic City, New Jersey (DNC)
WH Y	Hamer believed the vote was the fundamental right of citizenship; she refused to stop demanding it despite systematic brutality

■ Assassination of Medgar Evers and Myrlie Evers-Williams

NAACP leader Medgar Evers was assassinated in his Jackson driveway on June 12, 1963. His killer wasn't convicted until 1994. His widow Myrlie Evers-Williams continued his work and later chaired the NAACP (1995–1998).

WH O	Medgar Evers, NAACP Mississippi field secretary (victim); Myrlie Evers-Williams (widow and activist); Byron De La Beckwith (shooter, convicted 1994 — 31 years later)
WH AT	Evers was shot in his driveway by a sniper after returning from an NAACP meeting; Myrlie Evers-Williams continued his civil rights work for decades and served as NAACP national chair (1995–1998)
WH EN	June 12, 1963 (assassination); Beckwith convicted: February 1994
WH ERE	Jackson, Mississippi
WH Y	Evers was the most prominent civil rights organizer in Mississippi; his murder was intended to intimidate; instead it intensified the movement and galvanized national outrage

■ Eugenics and Forced Sterilization of Black Women

State eugenics programs (1930s–70s) disproportionately targeted poor Black women for forced sterilization — a state-sanctioned form of reproductive terror rooted in white supremacist pseudoscience that persisted into the 1970s.

WH O	Poor Black women (victims); state eugenics boards; complicit physicians and hospitals; North Carolina, Alabama, Mississippi, Georgia, Virginia among other states
WH AT	State-sanctioned involuntary sterilization programs targeting Black (and poor, Indigenous, and disabled) women; an estimated 60,000–65,000 total Americans forcibly sterilized under state eugenics laws, with Black women disproportionately targeted in later decades
WH EN	State eugenics laws from 1907 (Indiana, first); aggressive targeting of Black women especially 1930s–1970s
WH ERE	Southern states predominantly; North Carolina had one of the most aggressive programs
WH Y	White supremacist pseudoscience framed Black reproduction as a social threat; state governments used eugenics to control Black population growth under the guise of poverty reduction

UNIT 7 — THE ECONOMIC SYSTEM

Chapter 20: Convict Labor and the Roots of the Economic System

■ The Convict Lease System

The Convict Lease System (1865–1940s) exploited the 13th Amendment's 'punishment for crime' exception to re-enslave Black men through mass arrest on invented charges, leasing them to corporations in conditions of extreme brutality.

WH O	Primarily Black men (incarcerated for minor or fabricated offenses); Southern state governments; private corporations and landowners
WH AT	States leased Black prisoners to private businesses — railroads, mines, turpentine camps, plantations — under conditions indistinguishable from slavery; men wore chains, worked sunup to sundown, received no pay, and faced brutal punishment
WH EN	1865 (immediately after emancipation) – 1940s (formally ended at different times by state)
WH ERE	Throughout the South; notable in Alabama, Georgia, Mississippi, Tennessee, Florida, and Texas
WH Y	The 13th Amendment's exception allowing slavery 'as punishment for crime' was immediately exploited; states criminalized Black life (vagrancy laws, Black Codes) to re-enslave the newly freed

■ Texas State Capitol Constructed with Convict Labor

The Texas State Capitol (1882–1888) was built largely by approximately 500 convict laborers — predominantly Black men — who quarried and cut its granite under the state's convict lease system.

WH O	Approximately 500 convicts, predominantly Black men; Texas state government
WH AT	Convict laborers quarried and cut Sunset Red granite for the Texas State Capitol — one of the most prominent government buildings in the country
WH EN	1882–1888
WH ERE	Granite quarried at Marble Falls, Texas; Capitol in Austin, Texas
WH Y	Free convict labor dramatically reduced construction costs; the building stands as a monument that obscures the forced Black labor embedded in its construction

■ The Compromise of 1877 — End of Reconstruction

The Compromise of 1877 ended Reconstruction by withdrawing federal troops from the South in exchange for Hayes's presidency — directly handing Black Southerners back to unchecked white supremacist rule and enabling the rise of Jim Crow.

WH O	Republican leaders (Hayes supporters) and Democratic leaders (Tilden supporters); President Rutherford B. Hayes (beneficiary)
WH AT	A political deal resolved the disputed 1876 presidential election: Hayes became president; federal troops were withdrawn from the South; Reconstruction was effectively ended; Black Americans were abandoned to Southern white rule
WH EN	1877
WH ERE	Washington, D.C.
WH Y	Northern Republicans traded Black civil rights for political power; Southern Democrats demanded the end of federal intervention as their price for accepting Hayes's presidency

Chapter 21: HBCUs, Financial Literacy, and Wealth Building

■ Establishment of HBCUs

HBCUs (oldest: 1837; major expansion after 1865) were founded to provide Black Americans access to higher education after white institutions barred them — producing the majority of Black professionals through the mid-20th century.

WH O	Freedmen's Bureau; Black church denominations; northern philanthropists; pioneering Black educators
WH AT	Historically Black Colleges and Universities founded to provide higher education for Black Americans systematically excluded from white institutions; produced the majority of Black doctors, lawyers, teachers, and engineers through the mid-20th century
WH EN	Cheyney University of Pennsylvania (oldest HBCU): 1837; major growth post-1865 through Freedmen's Bureau
WH ERE	Predominantly in the South; also in northern states
WH Y	Black Americans were barred from white colleges and universities; HBCUs became the only avenue for Black higher education and professional training

■ 2019 HBCU Funding Legislation

On December 19, 2019, President Trump signed bipartisan legislation providing HBCUs with \$250M+ annually in permanent mandatory funding — the first such guarantee in federal history.

WH O	President Donald Trump; bipartisan congressional sponsors
WH AT	Legislation permanently providing HBCUs with more than \$250 million annually — the first permanent, mandatory HBCU funding in federal history
WH EN	Signed December 19, 2019
WH ERE	Washington, D.C.
WH Y	HBCUs had struggled against chronic underfunding and competition from white institutions now accepting Black students; permanent funding aimed to stabilize operations

■ Financial Literacy — Wealth Building Principles

BH365 emphasizes that financial literacy — especially homeownership, avoiding consumer debt, and resisting targeted advertising — is essential for Black Americans to close the racial wealth gap.

WH O	Black Americans broadly; Curtis Robinson (four laws); financial educators cited in BH365
WH AT	Core principles: live within your means; buy real estate (described as the best wealth-building investment); avoid credit card debt (leads to paying multiple times for purchases); set aside emergency savings; reject advertiser manipulation targeting Black disposable income
WH EN	Contemporary; principles timeless
WH ERE	United States
WH Y	The racial wealth gap — where median Black family wealth is a fraction of white family wealth — makes intentional wealth-building strategies critical for Black financial survival and advancement

Chapter 22: Black Entrepreneurs and Economic Empowerment

■ Annie Turnbo Malone — Poro Company (Revisited in Unit 7)

Malone's Poro Company (copyrighted 1902) trained thousands of Black women agents, funded Black institutions nationally, and predated Madam C.J. Walker's empire by four years — with Walker having worked as Malone's sales agent.

WH O	Annie Turnbo Malone
WH AT	Copyrighted the Poro brand by 1902; trained thousands of Black women as sales agents; built Poro College in St. Louis; donated to Howard University, the St. Louis Colored Orphans Home, and other institutions
WH EN	1902 (Poro brand copyrighted); peak operations 1910s–1920s
WH ERE	St. Louis, Missouri
WH Y	BH365 emphasizes that Malone preceded Madam C.J. Walker by four years and that Walker worked as Malone's Poro Agent before launching her own line

■ Madam C.J. Walker — First Female Self-Made Millionaire

Madam C.J. Walker (born 1867 to formerly enslaved parents) built a \$600K+ hair care empire (equivalent to millions today), leading a national salesforce of 40,000+ Black women agents and becoming America's first Black female self-made millionaire.

WH O	Sarah Breedlove / Madam C.J. Walker
WH AT	Born into poverty to formerly enslaved parents; worked as Malone's 'Poro Agent' for approximately one year; launched own hair care line; built national salesforce of 40,000+ agents; became one of the first self-made female millionaires in U.S. history
WH EN	Hair care business launched approximately 1905; peak empire 1910s; died 1919
WH ERE	Started in Denver, Colorado; headquarters in Indianapolis, Indiana; Villa Lewaro mansion in Irvington, New York
WH Y	Walker leveraged experience and entrepreneurial drive to build on — and far surpass — the market Malone had opened

■ Reginald Lewis — Wall Street Pioneer

Reginald Lewis opened Wall Street's first Black law firm (1970) and executed a record \$985M leveraged buyout of Beatrice International (1987), becoming the wealthiest Black man in America before his death in 1993.

WH O	Reginald Lewis
WH AT	Grew up in Baltimore; decided to pursue law at age 7; attended Virginia State University and Harvard Law School (as a special student); opened the first Black law firm on Wall Street; in 1987 executed a \$985 million leveraged buyout of Beatrice International — the largest ever by a Black businessman
WH EN	Law firm opened 1970; Beatrice deal: 1987; died: January 19, 1993
WH ERE	Baltimore (origin) → Wall Street, New York City
WH Y	Lewis was determined to prove Black excellence in corporate law and finance; became the wealthiest Black man in America at his peak

■ Cathy Hughes — Urban One / Radio One

Cathy Hughes built Radio One (1980, D.C.) into Urban One — the largest Black-owned media company in the U.S. and the first Black-woman-chaired publicly traded company — serving Black communities with culturally relevant media.

WH O	Cathy Hughes
WH AT	Founded Radio One in 1980 starting with a single Washington D.C. station; grew it into Urban One, the largest Black-owned media company in America; first Black woman to chair a publicly traded company
WH EN	1980 (Radio One founded); became publicly traded 1999; rebranded Urban One 2017
WH ERE	Washington, D.C. (origin); nationally expanded
WH Y	Hughes sought to give Black communities radio programming that reflected their lives, culture, and perspective — and to build Black-owned media infrastructure

■ Curtis Robinson — Law of Self-Sufficiency, First, Sacrifice, and Giving

Curtis Robinson's mother gave him four guiding principles — Self-Sufficiency, First, Sacrifice, and Giving — that provided a framework for economic survival and advancement after escaping Jim Crow Alabama.

WH O	Curtis Robinson
WH AT	Moved to Connecticut from Jim Crow Alabama; lives by four laws his mother taught him: Law of Self-Sufficiency, Law of First (put family first), Law of Sacrifice (delay gratification), Law of Giving (give back generously)
WH EN	Contemporary
WH ERE	Alabama (origin) → Connecticut
WH Y	Robinson's mother used these principles to guide a family escaping systemic Southern poverty; the laws represent a framework for Black economic survival and generational advancement

Chapter 23: Barack Obama, Mary McLeod Bethune, and the Presidency

■ Mary McLeod Bethune — Educator, Activist, Presidential Advisor

Mary McLeod Bethune (1904–1955) founded what became Bethune-Cookman University, co-founded the NCNW, and served as FDR's Director of Negro Affairs — the most politically powerful Black woman in American history up to that point.

WH O	Mary McLeod Bethune
WH AT	Founded Daytona Literary and Industrial Training School (1904) — now Bethune-Cookman University; co-founded the National Council of Negro Women (1935); served as FDR's Director of Negro Affairs in the National Youth Administration; the only Black woman in FDR's 'Black Cabinet'
WH EN	Founded school: 1904; FDR administration: 1936–1944
WH ERE	Daytona Beach, Florida; Washington, D.C.
WH Y	Bethune was committed to Black education and political power; she leveraged her access to FDR to direct New Deal resources toward Black communities

■ MLK Jr. Predicts a Black President — 1967

In 1967, MLK Jr. publicly predicted a Black U.S. president 'in the not so distant future' — a prediction fulfilled 41 years later with Barack Obama's 2008 election.

WH O	Dr. Martin Luther King Jr.
WH AT	At a press conference, King stated his belief that the United States would have a Black president 'in the not so distant future'
WH EN	1967
WH ERE	Press conference
WH Y	King pointed to the growth of Black political power and voter registration as evidence; his prediction was fulfilled 41 years later

■ Election of Barack Obama — 44th President

Barack Obama was elected the 44th President (Nov. 4, 2008) — the first African American to hold the office. He served two terms, won the Nobel Peace Prize (2009), and was Gallup's most admired American for 12 consecutive years.

WH O	Barack Obama; Vice President Joe Biden; campaign manager David Plouffe
WH AT	Obama won the 2008 presidential election, becoming the first African American president of the United States; served two full terms; Gallup named him the most admired man in America for 12 consecutive years
WH EN	Elected: November 4, 2008; inaugurated: January 20, 2009; served through January 20, 2017
WH ERE	United States
WH Y	Obama ran on a platform of hope, change, and national unity; won with a broad multiracial coalition; his election was both a historic milestone and a test of America's stated commitment to racial equality

■ Berea College — Education Without Racial Exclusion

Berea College (founded 1855, Kentucky) was a rare institution that admitted Black and white students from the start — a beacon of interracial education in a pro-slavery border state, referenced in BH365 as a model of possibility.

WH O	Berea College; abolitionist founders; Black and white students
WH AT	Founded in 1855 in a pro-slavery region of Kentucky; admitted Black and white students from its founding; charged no tuition; required students to work to fund operations
WH EN	Founded 1855
WH ERE	Berea, Kentucky
WH Y	Abolitionist founders believed in integrated, interracial education as a moral imperative; Berea remained a rare beacon of racial equality in the antebellum and Jim Crow South

Chapter 24: Language, Oppression, and Identity

■ Origins of the N-Word as a Tool of Racial Dehumanization

The N-word originated in 18th-century colonial America (from earlier Latin/Portuguese roots) as a deliberate dehumanization tool: colonizers used it to strip kidnapped Africans of identity and justify chattel slavery. Its use remains a form of racial oppression.

WH O	White European colonizers and enslavers (perpetrators); kidnapped Africans and their descendants (targets)
WH AT	Term derived from the Latin 'niger' (black); evolved through the colonial corruption 'Negar' into the current slur; used to strip Africans of humanity, justify enslavement, maintain racial hierarchy, and terrorize Black people across centuries
WH EN	18th century (documented colonial American usage); ongoing through present
WH ERE	Colonial America → United States
WH Y	Language was weaponized to construct a racial hierarchy: defining Africans as subhuman was essential to justifying the economic system of chattel slavery and maintaining white supremacist social order afterward

■ Prevailing Beliefs Against Black Physicians and Scientists

White medical institutions systematically barred Black physicians and scientists for centuries, using pseudoscientific claims of racial inferiority to justify exclusion — barriers whose effects on Black health and representation persist today.

WH O	Black physicians, surgeons, and scientists (targets); white medical and scientific establishments (perpetrators of exclusion)
WH AT	For centuries, white medical institutions denied Black doctors the ability to practice in white hospitals, attend medical schools, or publish in journals; junk science claimed Black people had inferior intellect or different pain tolerance
WH EN	17th century through mid-20th century (formally; informal barriers persist)
WH ERE	United States medical and scientific institutions
WH Y	Excluding Black professionals from medicine and science served to reinforce racial hierarchy and protect white economic dominance in those professions